

First U7/U8 session · checklist

Before the day

- ☐ Confirm venue, time, surface, qualified support and club safeguarding / first-aid arrangements.
- ☐ Tell families: named water, appropriate boots, covered shin pads and suitable clothing.
- ☐ Check attendance, relevant needs privately, emergency contacts and collection procedure.
- ☐ Pack a size 3 ball each, spares, flat cones, bibs and a watch.

Before play

- ☐ Walk the surface and run-off area; secure any portable goals.
- ☐ Mark boundaries and a visible resting / drinking place. Count children in.
- ☐ Assign adult duties for arrivals, late arrivals and any toilet / welfare needs.

A suggested first hour

- ☐ 0–10: greet, learn names, free dribbling. 10–20: find a different gate.
- ☐ 20–25: drink and demonstrate. 25–35: pair / trio gate passing or dribbling.
- ☐ 35–40: drink and reset. 40–55: short 2v2 / 3v3 games.
- ☐ 55–60: reflect, collect kit and hand over using the club's procedure.

During and after

- ☐ Show one action, give one cue and start. No heading practices.
- ☐ Offer water / rest; simplify or stop for fatigue, cold, injury or distress.
- ☐ Record one success, one difficulty and one next-session adjustment.

England 2026/27: U7 entry match format 3v3; U8 5v5. This checklist suggests training organisation, not an official fixture or FA-endorsed plan. Verify local and national-association requirements.

Notes for next week
